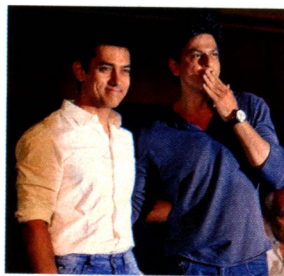
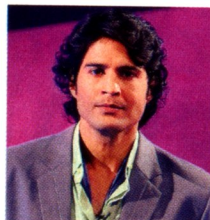


LOSER BOYS Cocaine. Vodka. Sex. Money. Devender Singh Dhillon's *emosional atyachar* transformed actor Abhay Deol into a cult star, made doing nothing seem like an art, setting off slacker clones.

WEIRDO WINNERS Channel heads politely called them characters. But reality show contestants seemed more like society rejects. Kamaal R. Khan extolled his own virtues on *Bigg Boss*, a self-proclaimed beauty queen regularly spewed abuse on UTV *Bindass' Big Switch* while *India's Got Talent* showed why India is a nation of eccentrics.



UNCUT ENTERTAINMENT Incest on *Sach Ka Saamna*. Long discussions on potty in *Paa*. *Kuch kuch hota hai* sung to the sound of a million abuses in *Kaminey*. A seduction special in *Uttaran*. TV and films boldly went where they hadn't before.



THE FEUDS They were the staple of tabloid television. A film industry stand-off, high-profile premieres of *Paa* and *3 Idiots*, and a Being Human fashion show organised by Salman Khan ensured that Khandom clashes were never far from the headlines.



THE MATING GAME Bollywood went off weddings but the biggest show of the year on TV, *Yeh Rishta Kya Kehlata Hai*, showed why the audience couldn't get enough of sangeets, mehndis and baraats in an extended family.

CHAMPION GIRLS Anandi in *Balika Vadhu* stood up for her parents. *Uttaran*'s Ichcha, the domestic's daughter, became the one Veer wanted to marry. And in *Sapna Babul Ka Bidaai*, cousins Ragini and Sandhana made it a Top 10 regular.

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actor in *Luck By Chance* or even the college girl-cum-prostitute in *Dev.D*. The men, unlike their noughties predecessors with rippling muscles and jobs that screamed success, tried to carve out a new work ethic, just as well in a year that began with the idealistic, Oscar winning *chaiwala* of *Slumdog Millionaire* and ended with three idiots who chased excellence, not success.

As a more confident nation stepped into its teenage years, it realised it didn't have to play by inherited rules. It could create

system. So whether it was Anurag Kashyap, the boy from Varanasi who finally made good with the hard hitting campus thriller *Gulal* and the eccentric *Dev.D*, or Rajkumar Hirani, the son of a typewriting institute proprietor from Nagpur, Bollywood knew inbreeding limited talent. No one expected perfection. If Maasa was occasionally soft, then Anandi was also occasionally wrong on *Balika Vadhu*. If Ammaji's idea of female empowerment was boiling little babies in milk, she also



Shahid Kapur *Kaminey*'s twins were faced with the choice of *ek* short cut and *ek chota* short cut, the former Shiamak Davar dancer showed he could act. Pity about *Dil Bole Hadippa*.

Katrina Kaif She couldn't speak Hindi but that didn't stop the actor from starring in two of the year's biggest hits. Who needed her to act?

Jaideep Sahni and Raju Hirani Sahni's *Rocket Singh* didn't take off commercially but Hirani's *Idiots* were a success. Yet both writers showed that it was possible to be a Mahatma in Bollywood's jungle.

its own. Authority was challenged everywhere, whether it was the compete-or-die principal of *3 Idiots*, the flower-shower father of *Wake Up Sid* or the Mumbai-for-Marathis politician of *Kaminey*. Young people onscreen refused to be silenced or cowed down, perhaps because more of them were coming from outside the

welcomed a strong woman as her daughter-in-law in *Naa Aana is Des Laado*.

Things were done that had never been done before. Wives went on TV to admit to wanting to cheat on their husbands in *Sach Ka Saamna*, while men threw bottles at one another in a fit of pique on *Bigg Boss* and women bathed in the open air on *Iss Jungle Se*